VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

School of Computing Science and Engineering

DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

Project Report

CSE0001 — Digital Literacy

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Introduction

> *"Digital literacy isn't just about knowing how to use technology. It's about using it responsibly, safely, and with purpose."*

When I first heard the words 'Digital Literacy course', I honestly didn't think much of it. I use a phone every day. I've had a WhatsApp account since school. How hard could it be?

It turned out to be one of the most practically useful things I've done since joining college. This project pushed me to do things I had been putting off for years: build a proper GitHub profile, learn what actually happens when you click a suspicious link, write an email that doesn't sound like a text message, and understand the tools that professionals use to collaborate and communicate.

This report documents my complete Digital Literacy Portfolio — five tasks, one per module of the CSE0001 course. Each task is a real deliverable, not just an exercise. The infographic I made could actually help a batchmate. The quiz I built could actually be used in class. The cybercrime case study could genuinely stop someone from losing their money.

I'm Ayush Kumar Yadav, a first-year B.Tech student at VIT Bhopal University. This is my attempt to show what it means to be digitally literate — not just in theory, but in practice.

Task 1 — Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Module 1

What I Made

I designed a one-page Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic using Canva — a free, browser-based design tool available at canva.com. The infographic was made with one audience in mind: first-year students at VIT Bhopal who are navigating the digital world for the first time without much guidance.

The design uses a light blue-to-purple gradient background with a clean vertical scroll layout — easy to read on both a phone screen and a laptop. Three sections are covered, each with its own colour theme and icon set:

Section	What It Covers
🌐 What is Digital Literacy?	A simple, student-friendly definition: the ability to find, evaluate, and communicate information using digital devices or platforms
💡 Useful Digital Tools for Students	Three tools every student should know: Notion (notes and planning), Google Docs (collaborative writing), and Trello (task and project management)
🔐 Safe Internet Practices	Three non-negotiable habits: use strong passwords, avoid suspicious links, and protect personal information online

Tool Used

Canva was the clear choice — it's completely free, needs no installation, and has templates designed specifically for educational infographics. I chose a minimal template and customised the colours, icons, and text to feel relevant to a student audience rather than a corporate one.

Reflection

Creating this infographic was more challenging than I expected — not technically, but editorially. The hardest part was deciding what to leave out. There was so much I wanted to

include: phishing, two-factor authentication, email etiquette, password managers. But a good infographic is not a textbook. If I put everything in, no one would read it.

So I made a deliberate choice: three topics, three clean sections, one clear message per section. The result is something I could actually hand to a batchmate and they'd read it in under two minutes.

The most interesting discovery was how much design affects comprehension. Choosing the right icon, the right amount of white space, and the right font size all determine whether a viewer actually absorbs the content — or just glances and scrolls past. This task changed how I think about communicating information digitally. A well-designed visual is not decoration. It's communication.

Task 2 — Student Digital Portfolio

Module 2

Platforms I Set Up

Before this task, I had heard of all three platforms. I had never actually sat down and built a real, intentional presence on any of them. That changed.

Platform	What It Is	What I Did
🐙 GitHub	The world's largest code hosting and version control platform — used by developers, students, and companies globally	Created a profile README with my name, branch, year, and one sentence about what I hope to learn during my degree
💼 LinkedIn	The world's largest professional networking platform — used for internships, jobs, and building a credible professional identity	Set up my Education section with current degree, institution (VIT Bhopal University), and expected graduation year
📊 Kaggle	The world's leading data science and machine learning community — competitions, datasets, notebooks, and structured learning paths	Created an account, explored beginner datasets, and set up a minimal profile ready for future data science activity

Reflection

The GitHub Profile README was the moment this task felt real. Writing a sentence about what I hope to learn felt small — but it was the first time I introduced myself to the global developer community, even if only in a quiet way. That matters.

Over the next four years, here is how I plan to use each platform:

- GitHub will be the home for every project, assignment, and personal experiment. By graduation, my profile should tell a four-year story of growth — not a last-minute dump of files before placement season.
- LinkedIn will be updated as things happen — internships, certifications, achievements — rather than built from scratch when I desperately need it.
- Kaggle will become my practice ground for data science from second year onwards. The structured learning paths are exactly the kind of guided exploration I need at this stage.

These are not just boxes ticked for a project. They are the beginning of a professional identity I plan to build deliberately over the next four years.

Task 3 — Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Module 3

Part A — HackerRank Coding Challenge

I created an account on HackerRank and completed the beginner-level 'Solve Me First' challenge: read two integers from input and print their sum. The code itself took two minutes. Everything around it took longer.

What I actually learned was not the code — it was the environment. How do you submit to an online judge? What does 'stdin' and 'stdout' mean in practice? Why does a correct-looking solution sometimes fail? Seeing a green 'Accepted' result for the first time felt genuinely rewarding. It's a small thing, but it was the start of something.

Part B — Google Forms Digital Literacy Quiz

I built a 5-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms in quiz mode, designed for my batchmates to actually use. Each question has four multiple choice options, correct answers configured, and instant feedback enabled.

#	Question	Topic Tested
1	What does 'phishing' refer to?	Cybercrime awareness
2	What to do if you receive a fake bank email?	UPI scam
3	How to verify links before clicking?	Digital safety
4	What does the padlock icon mean in a browser?	**network security** and **SSL/TLS encryption**
5	What is a VPN used for?	**Cybersecurity** and **Computer Networking**

Reflection

HackerRank showed me an entire ecosystem of structured programming practice that I had no idea existed. The platform has hundreds of challenges across languages, algorithms, and

data structures. I plan to commit to at least one challenge per week going forward — building consistency before the coursework gets harder.

The Google Forms quiz was a different kind of learning. I had used Forms before, but only as a respondent. Building one from scratch — thinking about what questions would genuinely test awareness rather than luck — was surprisingly thoughtful work. The quiz mode with instant scoring means I can actually share this with batchmates and it will function as a real awareness tool, not just a submission item.

Together, these tools represent two sides of digital skill: the ability to build and solve things technically, and the ability to create resources that others can use. Both matter. Both will be useful throughout my degree and beyond.

Task 4 — Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Module 4

Part A — Email 1: Assignment Extension Request

Subject: Request for Extension on Assignment Submission — CSE 0001 Digital Literacy

Dear Professor [Last Name],

I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to respectfully request an extension on the upcoming assignment for [Course Name/Code], currently due on [Date].

I'll be honest with you — this past week has been difficult. I've been dealing with [briefly explain: a health issue / unexpected family situation / overlapping deadlines] that has genuinely affected my ability to give this assignment the focus and effort it deserves. I didn't want to stay silent and submit something half-hearted — that wouldn't be fair to you or to myself.

I have already started working on it and made reasonable progress. I would be truly grateful if you could grant me an extension of 3–5 days, allowing me to submit by [proposed new date]. I am happy to provide any documentation you may need, and I remain fully committed to meeting all course requirements.

Thank you sincerely for your time and understanding, Professor.

Warm regards, [Your Full Name] | [Student ID] | [Course & Section] | [Contact]

Part A — Email 2: Summer Internship Interest

Subject: Application for Summer Internship Opportunity — [Your Name] | B.Tech [Branch], VIT Bhopal

Dear [Mr./Ms. Last Name],

I am [Your Name], a first-year B.Tech student in [Branch] at VIT Bhopal University. I came across your organisation while researching internship opportunities in [relevant field], and I wanted to reach out personally to express my genuine interest in a summer internship with your team.

I know I'm early in my academic journey — but I've been building relevant skills proactively: through coursework, platforms like HackerRank, and personal projects hosted on GitHub. I'm not just looking for something to put on a resume. I want to learn from people who are doing this work every day, and contribute meaningfully while I do.

I've attached my resume and GitHub profile link for your reference. I'd welcome any opportunity to discuss how I might contribute to your team this summer.

Thank you so much for your time and consideration.

Yours sincerely, [Your Full Name] | [Student ID] | VIT Bhopal University | [Email] | [Phone] github.com/[yourusername] | linkedin.com/in/[yourprofile]

Part B — Social Media Do's and Don'ts

#	☑ DO	✕ DON'T
1	Keep your profile photo and bio professional — you never know who's looking	Post anything you wouldn't want your professor, parent, or future employer to see
2	Set personal accounts to private and review settings every few months	Share your home address, phone number, or daily routine publicly
3	Use strong, unique passwords and enable 2FA on every platform	Use the same password across multiple accounts
4	Think before you post — is it true? Is it kind? Could it hurt someone?	Post or share unverified news, rumours, or misinformation
5	Use LinkedIn to share achievements, certifications, and learning milestones	Complain about college, faculty, or classmates online — ever

6	Report and block accounts that harass or send suspicious messages	Engage with or respond to cyberbullying — it escalates things
7	Always ask before tagging or posting photos of others	Accept friend/follow requests from people you don't know in real life
8	Log out of all accounts on shared or public devices (college labs, libraries)	Stay permanently logged in on any shared device
9	Review app permissions before granting access to contacts, camera, or location	Grant apps unnecessary permissions without reading what they do
10	Be kind and constructive online — your digital behaviour reflects your character	Post in anger or frustration — give yourself time to cool down first

Reflection

A scenario where poor digital communication caused a real problem: a student in my batch once sent an email to a professor that read something like 'hey sir can u give me more time for the assignment lol'. The professor didn't respond. The student couldn't understand why.

The request itself was completely reasonable. The communication was not. That one carelessly written message created a lasting impression — and the student didn't even realise it.

This task taught me that in the digital world, how you say something is just as important as what you say. A well-written email doesn't just show politeness — it signals that you take things seriously, that you respect the other person's time, and that you're someone worth responding to. That lesson will matter long after this course ends.

Task 5 — Cybercrime Awareness: Case Study & Prevention Guide

Module 5

Part A — Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

"The ₹50,000 That Vanished in 90 Seconds"

Meet Arjun. A 21-year-old engineering student in Pune, selling his old laptop on OLX to cover his semester fees. He posted the listing on a Sunday evening. By Monday morning, he had a buyer.

The buyer sounded perfect — polite, quick, no bargaining. 'I'll pay right now via Google Pay,' he said. 'Just scan this QR code to confirm your account.' Arjun scanned it. His phone asked for his UPI PIN. He entered it, assuming it was a verification step.

In 90 seconds, ₹50,000 left his account.

Step	What Happened
Step 1 — The Setup	The fraudster searched OLX and Quikr for active sellers — people who needed money and were already expecting a payment
Step 2 — Building Trust	He called Arjun, spoke confidently, confirmed the price immediately, and created urgency: 'I'm travelling tomorrow, let's do this now'
Step 3 — The Trick	He sent a collect request disguised as a payment QR code. In UPI, entering your PIN on a collect request means you are sending money — not receiving it
Step 4 — The Theft	The moment Arjun entered his MPIN, ₹50,000 was transferred to a mule account — untraceable within minutes
Step 5 — Gone	The phone number went unreachable. The OLX account was fake. The money was gone

Who Is Usually Targeted?

- Students and young adults selling gadgets, books, or furniture on OLX / Quikr / Facebook Marketplace
- Senior citizens unfamiliar with how UPI collect requests work

- Small vendors and freelancers expecting payments from new clients
- Homeowners listing items on resale platforms for the first time
- Anyone who is busy, distracted, or operating in a hurry — which is most of us, most of the time

Consequences

The aftermath hit Arjun harder than the money itself:

- Financial loss — ₹50,000 gone. His semester fees. His laptop fund. Wiped in 90 seconds.
- Emotional impact — shame, self-blame, and deep anxiety about using digital payments again
- No quick recovery — banks can freeze mule accounts, but fund recovery takes weeks or months with no guarantee
- Ongoing risk — his phone number, marked as a 'responsive' target, received scam calls for months after

> *"In UPI, you enter your PIN to SEND money — never to receive it. A QR code that asks for your PIN is taking money from you, not giving it. This is the one rule that would have saved Arjun everything."*

Source: Based on fraud patterns documented by the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (I4C) and consumer awareness reports by RBI and NPCI. Victim details are fictional but the method is real and actively reported across India.

Part B — Stay Safe Online: Prevention Checklist

#	Prevention Tip	Category
1	Never click links in emails or SMS messages claiming to be from your bank — type the URL directly in your browser	🎣 Phishing
2	Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) on every account — email, banking, social media, everything	🔐 Security
3	Use a strong, unique password for every platform — consider a free password manager like Bitwarden	🔐 Security
4	Keep your phone OS, apps, and antivirus updated — security patches fix real vulnerabilities that hackers exploit	📱 Device

5	Never share your OTP, UPI MPIN, ATM PIN, or CVV with anyone — not even someone claiming to be from your bank	💸 UPI Safety
6	You only enter your UPI PIN to SEND money. If someone asks you to enter your PIN to receive money — it is a scam	💸 UPI Safety
7	Avoid public Wi-Fi for banking and payments — use your mobile data or a VPN (like Proton VPN, free tier)	📶 Network
8	Check app permissions before installing — does a calculator really need access to your contacts and camera?	📥 Apps
9	Google yourself once in a while — know what the internet shows about you and adjust your privacy settings accordingly	🔍 Footprint
10	If you are targeted by cybercrime, report immediately at cybercrime.gov.in or call 1930 — speed matters for fund recovery	🚨 Reporting

🚨 **Report Cybercrime:** cybercrime.gov.in | Helpline 1930 (Free, 24x7, Government of India)

Reflection

What surprised me most while researching this topic was how sophisticated modern fraud has become. I had always pictured scam calls as obviously fake — bad grammar, generic greetings, desperate urgency. The UPI collect request scam is nothing like that. It is calm, professional, patient. The fraudster sounds like a legitimate buyer. The technical mechanism is invisible to someone who doesn't know how UPI works under the hood.

The one habit I have personally changed as a result of this task: I no longer approve UPI requests quickly. Before this project, I used to confirm transactions without reading the full description. Now I read every word before entering my MPIN — no matter how familiar the contact looks. It takes five extra seconds. It could save everything.

Conclusion

> *"I started this project thinking digital literacy was something I already had. I finished it realising it is something you build — deliberately, one good habit and one honest reflection at a time."*

This project has been the most practically useful work I have done since joining college. Unlike subjects that are tested on paper and forgotten, every deliverable here is something I can actually use: a GitHub profile that is live, a quiz that batchmates can take, emails I know how to write, and a clear understanding of the threats waiting online.

The five tasks together form a picture of what digital literacy really means: knowing your tools, building your presence, communicating professionally, staying safe, and understanding the threats. None of these are optional in 2026. They are the baseline.

As a Student Digital Ambassador, I also feel a genuine sense of responsibility toward my peers. Many of my batchmates don't know what a UPI collect request actually does. Many have never thought about what their LinkedIn profile looks like to an internship coordinator. Many have sent emails to professors that read like text messages and wondered why they didn't get a reply.

If even one person reads my infographic and changes a habit, or takes my quiz and learns something they didn't know, or avoids a scam because they remembered the rule about UPI PINs — then this project did exactly what it was supposed to do.

References

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- National Cyber Crime Helpline — 1930 (Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India)
- Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (I4C) — Fraud Pattern Reports
- Reserve Bank of India (RBI) — Consumer Awareness on Digital Payments
- National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) — UPI Safety Guidelines
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